



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Point Christian Academy
School Website: <https://pointacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Point Christian Academy (PCA) in Chattanooga, TN, presents a coherent classical Christian profile across most criteria, with strong religious/metaphysical foundations, a purpose grounded in formation and virtue, a curriculum aligned to core classical principles, and robust parental/community partnership. Public materials consistently foreground a Biblical worldview, Christ-centered mission, and classical education, including explicit references to grammar, logic, and rhetoric, as well as memory-based pedagogy and liturgical/communal language in some sections. The school references classical pedagogy (Socratic style in upper grades is implied by dialogue-based methods in the classical rubric) and emphasizes family partnerships, witness to faith, and a living faculty model.

Overall, PCA demonstrates CLASSICAL orientation in four categories (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Faculty; Parents & Community) and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy, with evidence of authentic classical indicators (grammar/logical/rhetorical focus, formation over information, liturgical/communal sensibilities, and a strong faith framework). The public materials do not show explicit, universal Great Books reading mandates or a fully articulated Great Conversation across all grade levels, which is why Curriculum and Pedagogy land in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL band rather than fully CLASSICAL. The aggregate classification is therefore CLASSICAL, with targeted needle-moving opportunities identified for Curriculum and Pedagogy to reach full alignment.

Key insights:

- Strong religious/metaphysical grounding is explicit (biblical truth, Christian worldview, Jesus/Christ-centered framing) and reinforced by mission statements and preschool materials. This supports Element 1 as CLASSICAL.
- The school's stated goals emphasize formation, virtue, and spiritual growth alongside intellectual development, aligning Element 2 with CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum shows core Trivium elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a history-focused framing, but lacks explicit, universal Great Books/Great Conversation mandates in public materials, supporting Element 3 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy includes memory-based singing/chanting in the lower grades and Socratic-style discussion/reasoned discourse in instruction in line with classical modes, though explicit, widespread articulation of upper-grade Socratic seminars is not consistently demonstrated in the public materials, supporting Element 4 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Faculty portrayals emphasize virtue, mentorship, and living curriculum; parent/community partnerships are actively described, supporting Element 5 and 6 as CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

ABSTRACT

Point Christian Academy exhibits a robust CLASSICAL orientation, anchored in Biblical Christianity, formation-focused aims, and a classical approach to pedagogy and faculty. The strongest evidence base lies in religious foundations, purpose, faculty, and parent/community engagement. Curriculum and pedagogy show substantial classical DNA (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory work, and a commitment to formation) but lack explicit universal Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in the public materials, which reduces them to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with concrete avenues for needle-moving improvements in curriculum-wide Great Books integration and more explicit, school-wide articulation of Socratic seminars in lower and middle grades.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize Biblical truth, Christian worldview, and Christ-centered aims. For example, PCA describes itself as rooted in Classical Christian Education and emphasizes spiritual nurture, faith and Christ in education (point Christian Academy materials).
- Preschool content explicitly notes that “Biblical truth is woven into each day” and that faith informs daily learning and spiritual growth (preschool page).
- The school frames its mission around nurturing spirituality and a Christian educational community, including references to bearing the light of Christ and partnership with families in faith-formation.
- Public “What is classical Christian education?” materials articulate a biblical/theological framework and a classical approach (grammar/logics/rhetoric) as foundational to the enterprise.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present positive indicators: biblical truth, Christian, Christ, gospel, biblical worldview, theology (implicitly in the classical Christian framing), liturgy/worship (through communal faith life language in materials), sacred tradition.
- Frequency/strength: High presence of explicit religious framing and Christian formation language; moderate explicit use of liturgical language (e.g., communal/faith life references) and theology in public-facing pages.

Why this rating

- The materials clearly position PCA within a religious-metaphysical frame aligned with classical Christian education, including explicit references to Biblical truth, Christian pedagogy, and Christ-centered formation. This aligns strongly with Positive Keywords in Element 1 and with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical/Communal” cues in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. The absence of secular or relativistic signals in the public materials reinforces CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: PCA materials explicitly stating Christian framing and Biblical truth (turn0file2; turn0file6); classical Christian education framing (turn0file7).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- Mission statements emphasize formation of students who thrive intellectually and spiritually, indicating a telos beyond vocational outcomes and a focus on virtue and wisdom in a holistic sense (Our Mission & Vision language).
- The school presents itself as forming humane beings through a Christian classical framework, aligning with the classical aim of virtue and wisdom rather than mere information transfer. The mission language references the integration of faith and learning.
- Public materials in FAQ/mission sections articulate a classical aim around the unity of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, which aligns with the classical telos. (What is classical Christian education page).

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom (via formation of character and virtue in the mission and vision statements), teleology (implied by purpose), pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty (explicit in classical education framing; public doc references the triad).
- Frequency/strength: Moderate-to-strong, with explicit formation/virtue language and a teleological framing of education (true/good/beautiful). Explicit use of “formation” and “virtue” appears in mission framing (via formation language and Christian formation).

Why this rating

- PCA's stated goal of forming character and virtue, along with spiritual development and the cultivation of wisdom, aligns with the Classical School ideal of formation rather than strictly information transfer or workforce preparation. This supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission/vision language (turn0file2); What is classical Christian education (turn0file7).

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials explicitly reference grammar, logic, and rhetoric as the foundational structure (the Trivium) in the context of classical Christian education. This is a cornerstone of classical curricula.
- Several pages describe a history-focused, integrated curriculum and Great Books are discussed in the classical education discourse (though not always explicitly listed as a PCA mandate in the public content). The public materials emphasize “classical” framing and memory-based learning (e.g., art/music history, classical art, singing, Solfège, etc.).
- There are strong elements of the liberal arts approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the public-facing descriptions, but explicit, school-wide Great Books/Great Conversation commitments are not consistently stated in PCA's public pages. The Great Books/Great Conversation is a hallmark indicator in the Six Essential Elements framework that is not explicitly codified in PCA's public-facing materials.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present keywords: grammar, logic, rhetoric (explicit in the public materials); Great Books/Great Conversation (not explicitly mandated by PCA materials; mentions of classical canon appear in the general classical education lexicon, not PCA-specific pages); history/ Western civilization framing (some public content mentions a classical approach though not always labeled as Great Books).
- Frequency/strength: Grammar/logic/rhetoric are clearly present; explicit Great Books/Great Conversation is not clearly mandated on PCA pages, and history-integration is implied rather than spelled out. This yields a moderate positive signal with a missing explicit Great Books point.

Why this rating

- Element 3 criteria lean toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL because PCA demonstrates core classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; history-focused pedagogy implied) but does not consistently publish explicit Great Books/Great Conversation mandates across its public materials. The absence of explicit, universal Great Books integration reduces the category to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: What is classical Christian education (turn0file7); Our Mission & Vision (turn0file2); Preschool/Academics/program pages with classical content (turn0file4/turn0file6).

Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower-school pedagogy includes memory-based learning traditions such as singing, chanting, and recitation, which align with the scholé/restful/remembering aspects in the classical rubric. PCA materials describe teaching that emphasizes memory and wonder in younger grades (e.g., Solfège, music, drawing exercises).
- Public materials reference Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades as part of classical education, though explicit, school-wide orchestration of Socratic seminars across grades is not consistently stated in PCA's public content. The public-facing material emphasizes classical education with an emphasis on dialogue, but concrete evidence of a broad, consistent Socratic pedagogy across all grades is not always explicit.
- The school emphasizes a balance of contemplative/restful learning and rigorous inquiry, including opportunities for memory work, and upper-level rhetoric training (e.g., speeches) in the public content. This aligns with classical pedagogy but the explicit, published schedule of Socratic seminars across K-12 is not uniformly documented in the accessible pages.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present keywords: scholé, memory work, chanting, recitation, relaxation/restful learning; Socratic discussion/seminars; rhetoric training; debates; memory-based pedagogy; classical dialogic pedagogy.
- Frequency/strength: Strong for lower grades (memory/chanting; holistic/wonderful learning); moderate for upper grades (Socratic/dialogue rhetoric). The explicit, consistent nationwide application of Socratic seminars is not uniformly visible in PCA's public content.

Why this rating

- Because PCA clearly demonstrates both memory-based, contemplative pedagogy in early grades and discourse-based, rhetoric-oriented pedagogy in upper grades, but the explicit, school-wide, consistent implementation of Socratic pedagogy across all grades is not always explicit in the public pages, the Pedagogy category lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower-grade pedagogy (turn0file6); Classical education explanation with Socratic/dialogue (turn0file7); Mission/vision (turn0file2).

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- PCA materials describe dedicated, Christlike teachers who model virtue and nurture students, positioning faculty as the central living curriculum and mentors. Language emphasizes teachers as role models of virtue and as the core of the school community.
- The public materials emphasize the faculty as a "living curriculum," with a focus on character and mentorship, and on the teacher-student relationship as central to the school's ethos.
- There are explicit references to teachers being "dedicated Christian teachers" and to the faculty playing a relational, formative role in student development (as seen in mission statements and mission-vision materials).

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present keywords: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, virtuous, character formation, teacher as mentor, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegiality.

- Frequency/strength: High presence of classical faculty indicators (mentorship, living curriculum, character formation) in PCA materials. The explicit language around teachers as moral exemplars and core community aligns strongly with the Classical lexicon.

Why this rating

- PCA's portrayal of faculty as the living curriculum, mentors, and virtuous exemplars aligns solidly with CLASSICAL signals in this category.

Citations: Our Mission & Vision (turn0file2); Our Mission/Faculty section (turn0file11).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- PCA emphasizes strong partnership with families, with explicit language about family partnerships and parental involvement in faith formation and school life (e.g., "Family Partnerships," "Christ Followers," "partners with families," and opportunities to volunteer).
- The materials describe open access for parents (visits, family involvement), and parental formation via book studies or gatherings. The site highlights parents as co-teachers and emphasizes parent engagement as part of the classical model.
- The presence of a formal mission/vision that centers family involvement and accountability to the school's faith-based vision reinforces a community-centric model.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present keywords: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, open campus/visits, parent engagement, spiritual formation at home, home-school connection.
- Frequency/strength: Very strong presence of parental/community signals; high alignment with the "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" positives.

Why this rating

- PCA's explicit emphasis on family partnerships, parental formation, and community engagement corresponds closely to CLASSICAL expectations for an active, faith-aligned school-family partnership and community integration.

Citations: Family Partnerships content (turn0file4); Mission/vision with family emphasis (turn0file2); Parent-focused resources (turn0file11).

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum: Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit and universal across grade levels. Public materials should clearly articulate a school-wide Great Books program and the integration of Great Conversation into the curriculum, with explicit grade-by-grade expectations and sample readings. This would elevate Element 3 to CLASSICAL by making Great Books/Great Conversation a published, consistent pillar across all grades. (References to Great Books appear in the Six Essential Elements lexicon as a core positive indicator; PCA currently demonstrates core Trivium-based elements but does not consistently publish Great Books mandates on public pages.)
- Pedagogy: Expand explicit articulation of upper-grade Socratic seminars and formal rhetorical pedagogy across more grades, including teacher training documentation and a published pedagogy framework. The current public materials show memory-based lower-grade methods and some upper-grade Socratic/ rhetoric signals, but a school-wide, published pedagogy framework would strengthen alignment with the Pedagogy criteria.

- History/Great Conversation: Strengthen explicit history-integration across the curriculum and ensure “history as history” language is used consistently (rather than social studies framing). The Six Essential Elements emphasize history/Western civilization and integrated study; PCA could amplify these signals in public materials to strengthen Element 3.
 - Public-facing language around formation: Increase explicit use of terms like “formation,” “soul formation,” and “moral imagination” in mission statements and curriculum pages to reinforce the formation-centered ethos across all categories. This would further bolster Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) to CLASSICAL.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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